1984 notes

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book and movie

- 1984 PDF book on GlobalGreyBooks
  - local copy of PDF
- [1984 for browser at Project Gutenberg(http://gutenberg.net.au/ebooks01/0100021h.html)
  - local copy of 1984 for browser
  - local copy of 1984 in markdown format (this is plain text with formatting info, that is easily searchable)
- local copy of 1984 for browser

Quotes from 1984 at Goodreads

- “Perhaps one did not want to be loved so much as to be understood.”
- “Who controls the past controls the future. Who controls the present controls the past.”
- “War is peace. Freedom is slavery. Ignorance is strength.”
- “The best books… are those that tell you what you know already.”
- “If you want to keep a secret, you must also hide it from yourself.”
- “If you want a picture of the future, imagine a boot stamping on a human face—for ever.”
- “We shall meet in the place where there is no darkness.”
- “It was a bright cold day in April, and the clocks were striking thirteen.”
- “Doublethink means the power of holding two contradictory beliefs in one’s mind simultaneously, and accepting both of them.”
- “Until they become conscious they will never rebel, and until after they have rebelled they cannot become conscious.”
- “Now I will tell you the answer to my question. It is this. The Party seeks power entirely for its own sake. We are not interested in the good of others; we are interested solely in power, pure power. What pure power means you will understand presently. We are different from the oligarchies of the past in that we know what we are doing. All the others, even those who resembled ourselves, were cowards and hypocrites. The German Nazis and the Russian Communists came very close to us in their methods, but they never had the courage to recognize their own motives. They pretended, perhaps they even believed, that they had seized power unwillingly and for a limited time, and that just around the corner there lay a paradise where human beings would be free and equal. We are not like that. We know that no one ever seizes power with the intention of relinquishing it. Power is not a means; it is an end. One does not establish a dictatorship in order to safeguard a revolution; one makes the revolution in order to establish the dictatorship. The object of persecution is persecution. The object of torture is torture. The object of power is power. Now you begin to understand me.”
- “Power is in tearing human minds to pieces and putting them together again in new shapes of your own choosing.”
- “If you loved someone, you loved him, and when you had nothing else to give, you still gave him love.”
- “In the face of pain there are no heroes.”
- “Reality exists in the human mind, and nowhere else.”

1984, directed by Michael Radford, free on TubiTV, 1:50:33

1984 review by Roger Ebert

- PDF version
- AI summary:
  The article describes the 1984 film adaptation of George Orwell’s novel. The film captures the bleak and oppressive atmosphere of the novel, using props and visuals that evoke a sense of decay and disrepair. The article also highlights the film’s faithful adaptation of the novel’s themes and characters, particularly the complex relationship between Winston Smith and Julia.

from Analyzing the Movie - 1984

This movie often uses low-key lighting and close-up shots. The low-key lighting is often used when Winston visited the areas where the Outer party members and proles lived. This use of lighting further emphasizes the lack of wealth in those areas. Many times during gatherings, close-up shots were used to study the faces of Julia, Winston, and many other characters to show their reactions towards the “propaganda” thrown at them.

1984 movie vs book

from What are the main differences between the film and novel 1984?

The 1984 film is noted for being closer to the original book, though there are still a few differences. This version creates a distinct hand salute for the Party, evoking Nazi Germany, and the Party's members also refer to one another as "brother" and "sister" rather than the more overtly Soviet "comrade" as in the novel. Otherwise, this version retains Orwell's bleak finale.

from Novel vs. Movie - 1984

Whenever a novel is translated into a movie, the director might decide to change the plot to fit his understanding and interpretation of the book. In the movie adaption of 1984, the director followed the novel fairly well with no drastic changes. However, here are three differences between the movie and the novel:

In the novel, the interactions between Winston and Julia are spread out over many months. They are unable to meet frequently. The book draws out the details about how Winston and Julia try to meet up. It isn't until a couple months later that Winston and Julia unite at the second story of Mr. Charrington's building. Yet, in the movie, it appears that everything is hastened; Winston and Julia quickly move into the building, skipping a lot of the previous encounters. This was probably done because the movie is a condensed version, so the individual encounters were removed because they are insignificant to the overall plot.

One of the starkest differences between the movie and the novel occurs when Winston goes to meet O'Brien. In the novel, Winston goes with Julia, and they talk in length with O'Brien about the Brotherhood. He questions them and warns them about the consequences of joining the Brotherhood. However, in the movie, only Winston goes to meet O'Brien. The meeting was quick and brief. O'Brien merely suggests that he reads Goldstein's book. I felt that this was an unnecessary omission because without the detailed encounter, I was slightly confused with the conversion in the movie.

In the novel, the diary entries are all at the beginning of the novel. The director decided to integrate the journal entries into the story, which I thought was a good idea. After a few scenes, there is a scene of Winston writing in the diary. The diary entries are all the same, but when they are written in relation to other events are different.

from What's the Difference between Nineteen Eighty-Four the Book and 1984 the Movie?

Book	Movie
Ingsoc's salute is a clenched fist.	The salute is the crossing of the forearms to make an X.
Party members refer to each other as "Comrade".	They call each other "brother" and "sister".
Winston works at the Records Department.	It is called the Mini-Rec.
The Ministry of Plenty is called the Mini-plenty.	It is named the mini-prod.
Winston and Julia go together to visit O'Brien's private residence in the Victory Mansions. They are looking for information about joining the Brotherhood.	Winston goes alone and it isn't clear that he is looking for information about the Brotherhood.
O'Brien reveals that he is a member of the Brotherhood.	It is not clear.
Eurasia and Eastasia respectively follow the ideologies of Neo-Bolshevism and "Death-Worship".	This isn't mentinoed.

Book	Movie
Winston is given an identical briefcase to his own that contains Goldstein's book. This is a pretext for getting the address to O'Brien's apartment.	Winston is at O'Brien's apartment when he is given the book. It is disguised as a Newspeak dictionary.
Winston's spirit is broken, and he submits to his love for Big Brother.	Winston cannot bring himself to love Big Brother, though he was broken, his spirit was too strong.

DID THE HEART OF ORWELL'S '1984' GET LOST IN THE MOVIE?, NY Times 1985-02-24,

- AI summary
  The film "1984" preserves the plot but omits Orwell's essays on Newspeak and doublethink. Michael Radford's adaptation lacks the novel's conceptual depth, yet Winston Smith's surrender to INGSOC and Big Brother remains.

commentary on 1984

Afterword to the 1961 Signet edition of *1984*, by Eric Fromm,

- website copy of PDF

Claude AI Summary of Fromm's Afterward

Fromm wrote this afterword in 1961 for the Signet edition, and his main argument is that *1984* is both a mood and a warning. The mood is near-despair about humanity's future. The warning is that people may become soulless automatons without ever noticing it has happened.

From utopia to negative utopia. Fromm sets the novel inside a 2,000-year Western tradition of hope in human progress. That tradition runs through the Hebrew prophets, Christian thought, and Renaissance utopias such as More's *Utopia*, Campanella's *City of the Sun*, and Andreae's *Christianopolis*, and it continues up to Bellamy's *Looking Backward*. He traces the collapse of this hope to the period from World War I onward: Stalin's betrayal of socialism, the Depression, Nazism, the bombing of civilian cities, and finally the hydrogen bomb. Zamyatin's *We*, Huxley's *Brave New World*, and *1984* form a new trilogy of "negative utopias" that mirrors the old positive one. He calls the shift a historical paradox. Early modern people were hopeful even though they lacked the means to end scarcity and war. Modern people have those means and are losing hope just as it becomes realizable.

The shared question. All three books ask whether human nature can be changed so completely that people forget their longing for freedom, dignity, love, and truth. Fromm notes that none of the authors treats human nature as a blank slate. The extreme methods each one needs to crush it (lobotomy in *We*, eugenics and drugs in Huxley, torture and brainwashing in Orwell) actually show how strong those human strivings are. Still, all three conclude that dehumanization is possible with techniques already known.

What Orwell specifically contributes: - **Permanent war.** Ongoing arms production props up the economy, and a society that is always preparing for annihilation cannot stay democratic. Fromm turns this directly against Cold War deterrence: the arms race would destroy freedom even if the bombs never fell. - **The abolition of objective truth.** The Party holds that reality exists only in the mind, so controlling minds means controlling truth. Fromm compares O'Brien's interrogation of Winston to Dostoevsky's Grand Inquisitor, with one difference: the Party doesn't even claim to want people's happiness. It wants power for its own sake. He links this to Alan Harrington's idea of corporate "mobile truth," where a product is "the best" for as long as you work for the company that makes it. In such a system, a minority of one has to conclude that he is insane. - **Doublethink is already here.** Fromm's examples are Western. The "free world" includes dictatorships such as Franco's and Salazar's. Herman Kahn's nuclear strategy calmly

expects tens of millions of deaths followed by "normal and happy lives," and that reasoning is called "sober." Christian nations plan mass killing with few qualms. - **Successful manipulation means people believe the lie.** They aren't saying the opposite of what they think. They actually think the opposite of what is true, so "Slavery is Freedom" feels like freedom. The West also falsifies its own ideology when it calls a centralized, bureaucratic, materialist managerial society "individualist."

Conclusion. Fromm doubts that a fully dehumanized society could even survive, because it would be a world of madmen, hinted at in the "mad gleam" in the Party leader's eye. He reads Orwell as a warner, not a prophet of doom. The real danger is managerial industrialism itself, which "builds machines which act like men and develops men who act like machines," and it applies under any ideology. Orwell's hope is a desperate one, and it depends on readers recognizing that the book is about *us*, not only about Stalinism.

A paragraph from Afterward that Connects Doublethink of Corporatism and Rejection of Outliers

If I work for a big corporation which claims that its product is better than that of all competitors, the question whether this claim is justified or not in terms of ascertainable reality becomes irrelevant. What matters is that as long as I serve this particular corporation, this claim becomes "my" truth, and I decline to examine whether it is an objectively valid truth. In fact, if I change my job and move over to the corporation which was until now "my" competitor, I shall accept the new truth, that its product is the best, and subjectively speaking, this new truth will be as true as the old one. It is one of the most characteristic and destructive developments of our own society that man, becoming more and more of an instrument, transforms reality more and more into something relative to his own interests and functions. Truth is proven by the consensus of millions; to the slogan "how can millions be wrong" is added "and how can a minority of one be right." Orwell shows quite clearly that in a system in which the concept of truth as an objective judgment concerning reality is abolished, anyone who is a minority of one must be convinced that he is insane.

Claude Summary of Not Death, but Annihilation: Orwell's Nineteen Eighty-Four and the Catastrophe of Englishness, Erik Jaccard, local copy

Erik Jaccard, "Not Death, but Annihilation: Orwell's *Nineteen Eighty-Four* and the Catastrophe of Englishness" (Critical Insights, 2016, pp. 98–112)

The argument in one line: *1984* is usually read as a universal warning about humanity under totalitarianism, but it is also an *English catastrophe novel*, and when you read it that way, the "humanity" Winston defends turns out to be English culture.

The target. Jaccard opens with Fromm's Afterword as the example of the reading he wants to complicate. Fromm, and Trilling with his view of Orwell as a teller of truths above politics, treat the novel as a statement about "man" in modernity. Jaccard says this depends on reading the book through only one genre.

Two genres, two lenses. - *Dystopia* puts the society first and characters second. The protagonist does two jobs: he shows how the system works, and he carries a counter-narrative of resistance. Winston's diary, the affair with Julia, and the Brotherhood all fit, and O'Brien's "you are the last man" frames the stakes as humanity itself. - *The English catastrophe novel* emerged in late-Victorian anxiety about imperial decline, made sharper by Darwin's suggestion that civilizations can regress as well as progress. Disaster shrinks the world down to England, strips survivors back to basics, and tests "Englishness" under pressure. These books often expose imperial hypocrisy, then end by rebuilding the new world on English values. The critique of empire quietly restores it.

Why *1984* qualifies. Oceania comes after nuclear war, so it is literally post-catastrophic. With the past erased, London is effectively an island. Unlike a typical dystopian hero, who is at home in his world, Winston looks backward like a catastrophe survivor. The key moment is the toast: offered the future, humanity, or the death of Big Brother, he chooses "the past."

Englishness as "ancestral memory." Jaccard reads Winston's vague bodily sense that things were once different, his longing for the private room above Charrington's shop, and the Golden Country alongside Orwell's essay "England Your England." In that essay, Englishness is a felt, unconscious continuity of

privacy, gentleness, and individual liberty, living beneath the surface of official life. Winston feels freedom is his *right* not as a human being but because being free is what an Englishman naturally does. In Conor Cruise O'Brien's critique, Orwell never seriously imagined being part of a people with a different history. So the novel's universal defense of humanity is built on a parochial base.

The title. Winston and Julia believe "they can't get inside you." Orwell's patriotic writing assumes the same thing: individuals die, but the English spirit persists, and a turnip seed never grows into a parsnip. Room 101 refutes this. Jaccard goes further than Jonathan Rose's point that the horror is "there won't always be an England." The real despair, he argues, is that the cultural ground from which individual life grows is annihilated, and not merely killed. He adds that Winston's resistance itself seems to have been engineered: the recurring dream of O'Brien's voice, the pull toward the prole district, the exculpatory scrap of paper conveniently "slipped in." The Party has co-opted the very instinct for Englishness that freedom depended on. That co-optation is the catastrophe.

Quetions for Our Course:

- Can the longing for freedom be extinguished, or does human nature push back, as a defiance to mind control?
- Does the severity of the methods used by the state prove the strength of what they suppress?
- Is history really written by the victors?. Is truth written by those in power?
- How does 1984 look different when seen through the lens of English Catastrophe?

The Meaning of 'War Is Peace. Freedom Is Slavery. Ignorance Is Strength',

Interesting Literature, Dr Oliver Tearle (Loughborough University),

- local copy as PDF

AI summary:

In Nineteen Eighty-Four, the slogans "War Is Peace," "Freedom Is Slavery," and "Ignorance Is Strength" manipulate meaning. Goldstein's text explains that perpetual internal war preserves hierarchy, making war and peace interchangeable.

Cuts of 1984, Cin Movie

Total time is 1:33:41 = 7:47 + 9:38 + 7:01 + 7:33 + 8:14 + 8:28 + 2:15 + 9:53 + 5:23 + 9:23 + 9:59 + 7:47 . This is more than 1hr10min, the total running time of Radford's 1984, because some cuts have overlapping parts.

- Big Brother Is Watching - 1984 - movie - YouTube, 7:47
- Life Under the Party's Control, 9:38
- Rewriting History, 7:01
- Seeds of Rebellion, 7:33
- A Forbidden Affair, 8:14
- The Thrill of Defiance, 8:28
- The Brotherhood's Allure, 2:15
- Living in Fear, 9:53
- Captured by the Thought Police, 5:23
- The Torture of Bertrayal, 9:23
- Room 101, 9:59
- The Power of Big Brother, 7:47

about George Orwell

- George Orwell - Wikipedia
- The Orwell Society, Promoting life & works of George Orwell
- The Road to 1984 | Full Movie | James Fox as George Orwell (1984), YouTube 1:26:31

  Descripton: James Fox plays writer George Orwell, from his time as a policeman to his death from TB in 1950. Interspersed are dramatised extracts from both 1984 and Animal Farm. Broadcast 19th January 1984

  AI Summary: Classic British Telly explores the life and motivations of Eric Arthur Blair, the celebrated writer known as George Orwell. This biographical drama examines the experiences and political convictions that shaped such iconic works as Animal Farm and 1984, tracing a journey from service in Burma to the intellectual struggles of a dedicated journalist.

YouTube videos about the book/movie, sorted in order of increasing length

- "The government wouldn't do that!" | 1984 Edit - YouTube, 0:21
  - "1984" and real clips -> "oh, yes they would"
- Why George Orwell's 1984 Still Matters Today - YouTube, 0:57
  - Anti-Harris ad!
- Mix - 1984 - All hail Oceania - YouTube, 1:25
  - clips set to song "All Hail Oceania"
- 1984 (1/11) Movie CLIP - Two Minutes Hate (1984) HD - YouTube, 2:41
  - last 30 seconds is Movie CLIP add
  - clip at beginning of movie
- **1984 by George Orwell in two minutes. - YouTube, 2:55**
  - animated audio
- 1984 George Orwell Full Book Summary (Full Book in JUST 3 Minutes) - YouTube, 3:36 (after advertisement)
  - animated audio, calmer and more detailed then above
- Orwell 1984 - O'Briend about Power, 4:07
  - clips
  - O'Brian: How Does one Man Inflict Power
    - Power is tearing minds apart and putting them back together …
    - Past is forbidden … cut many from his family and other men …
    - No love but love of Big Brother
    - Boot stamping on human face forever.
    - … I'm old, but only a cell in a bigger organism.
- Winston: You'll fail, Hatred and Fear have no life … life will defeat you.
- O'Brian: We control life at all levels
  - Proletarian … are helpless animals
- Winston: In end they will beat you. … Goldstein's book.

- O'Brian: I collaborated in writing it.
- Winston: Some spirit you will never overcome. … Spirit o mean.
- O'Brian: Your kind is extinct. You are outside history … You Unexist.
- **George Orwell's 1984: Why it still matters - BBC News - YouTube, 4:57, about 2019**
  - clips from 1950's BBC version of 1984
  - Background on Orwell. How he reproduced things he saw.
  - doublethink, newspeak, rewrite history and reality
  - no word for freedom, extreme surveillance
  - people talked of book in 1950s -> distort the meaning
    - e.g. thought police is much more than "political correctness"
  - different aspects of books come out at different times
    - in 1950s it was critique of stalinism
    - late 1980s - warning against computer databases and TV cameras
    - recently about truth and flagrant lies
  - multiple meanings is remarkable!
- Nineteen Eighty-Four (1984) - Thought Crime - YouTube, 5:46
  - clip early on of Winston in Ministry of Truth, coming home to confession of thought crime in following Goldstein
  - Winston, "Thought Crime is Death … I have committed, even before committing to paper."
  - journal behind brick in "hidden" part of room
  - first entry, April 4, 1984.
    - greeting to future from a dead man
  - memories of field and running in rouble as a child
- 1984 by George Orwell, Part 1: Crash Course Literature 401 - YouTube, 14:27
- The Dystopian World of 1984 Explained - YouTube, 15:25
- Is 1984 Becoming a Reality? - George Orwell's Warning to the World - YouTube, 15:40
- 1984: Great Books Explained - YouTube, 19:55
- Are We Getting Closer to Orwell's Nightmare? | 1984 Explained, 25:59
- Why Orwell's 1984 Feels Disturbingly Relevant Right Now - YouTube, 27:34
- Why Does Everyone Think "1984" Agrees With Them? - YouTube, 44:36
- 1984 Tried To Warn You - YouTube, 50:03
- Why 1984 Still Feels So Real Today - YouTube, 1:25:45
- The Road to 1984 | Full Movie | James Fox as George Orwell (1984), 1:26:31
  - "James Fox plays writer George Orwell, from his time as a policeman to his death from TB in 1950. Interspersed are dramatised extracts from both 1984 and Animal Farm."

1984 in the news

I'll just give one out of many, many examples.

from Citing Orwell's '1984,' judge orders Trump administration to restore slavery exhibit it removed in Philadelphia | PBS News

Rufe, an appointee of Republican President George W. Bush, began her written order with a quote from George Orwell's dystopian novel "1984" and compared the Trump administration to the book's totalitarian

regime called the Ministry of Truth, which revised historical records to align with its own narrative.

"As if the Ministry of Truth in George Orwell's 1984 now existed, with its motto 'Ignorance is Strength,' this Court is now asked to determine whether the federal government has the power it claims — to dissemble and disassemble historical truths when it has some domain over historical facts," Rufe wrote. "It does not."

quotes from the book *1984*

Definition of Doublethink, quote in Fromm's afterward

"Doublethink means the power of holding two contradictory beliefs in one's mind simultaneously, and accepting both of them. … This process has to be conscious, or it would not be carried out with sufficient precision. But it also has to be unconscious, or it would bring with it a feeling of falsity and hence of guilt."